

* External Challenges :-

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- US
- Russia
- China

Internal Challenges :-

i) Economic challenge -

Bringing Economic Growth back on track.

a) Since Global Financial Crisis (2007-08)

There has been tensions b/w US and China
tariff war, trade war with EU, Covid
Crisis, Ukraine Crisis

Why they need to sustain the momentum of
their Economy. ? -

If people don't find it advantageous to go for
Supra-Nationalism rather increase their burdens
they will have resentment against expression
of Supra-Nationalism.

Unemployment Crisis has already given way to
the rise of Far Right even in the countries
like - Sweden, Italy, France, this will revive
Old Politics (Ultra-Nationalism & Protectionism) it
means Ghost of Past looms large today.

* Policy of European Countries :-

Since their dependency is huge on China, they do not want Enmity with China. They only want that China give better terms of trade.

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In this Context, we can see France approach to China. France thinks that Chinese investment if transparent can spur the Growth.

However, the experience of China is such that China will not mend its ways. Hence, they also want to diversify the supply chain means look towards Make in India.

EU faces internal Challenges in the sense that the countries of EU are divided on multiple lines. -

- i) Europhobic Nations (Denmark) Vs Europhilic Nations (Germany, France).
- ii) Pro-US Vs Anti-US.
(Poland & Germany) (France)
- iii) Pro-China ← Anti-China
(Italy, Greece, Countries of South-Central Europe) (Germany)
- iv) Rich Europe ← Poor Europe
(Former ~~Eastern~~ Communist Countries & Pigs Economy like Spain)

The countries w/c has recently joined EU lack Commitment to the EU values like - Democracy, Human Rights, etc.

* Maritime Dialogue (2022)

* Participation in Golden Gateway Project

} → these are left in Relations b/w India and Europe.

* India — Russia Relations *

* Views of P.M. Modi (2014) :-

BRICS Summit in Brazil :-

Every child in India knows who is India's best friend — Russia.

In order to describe India-Russia Relations, the preferred word is —

- a) Long Standing
- b) Time tested.

* Views of Foreign Minister (S. Jayshankar) —

Russia has been the key pillar in India's Nation building.

March 2023 — Putin has released the Foreign Policy ~~National Security~~ Concept.

Strategy. A key document to interpret the directions of a Foreign Policy of any country.

● Salient Features :-

- ① It points towards the unjust policies of the west. It gives the idea of the Firm Resolve of Russia to challenge the western Dominated World Order.

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Implications for India — we are passing through the time when India's Relations with the west were never as good as today.

Be it US or Europe — Britain, Germany, France, Italy.

Till war in Ukraine, Russia's Relation with US were tensed but not with Europe. Thus, present Geo-Political Environment pulls the two Strategic Partners or the Best Friends in the opposite directions.

So far, the Friendship has stood Firm but

Future is not certain.

Foreign Policy Concept

- ② The ¹~~Strategy~~ also points towards building the Multi-Polar world. It also mentions that Russia will work with i.e. China & India to create a more just world order.

Implications for India :-

i) India shares the vision of the multi-Polar world but Russia's Reliance on China proves to be an idealistic concern. In the current State of India - China Relations.

S. Jayshankar used to describe the relation as abnormal but now he describe it as dangerous. Hence, the ^{talk}~~top~~ of Russia - India - China triangle, does not augur well in current circumstances.

There may be inbuilt hesitation from India to work with China.

We should not ignore the Fact that in recent year, Russia - China have become too close.

- a) Russia does not recognise the concept of Indo-Pacific. On the other hand, India has invested a lot in Indo-Pacific initiative.
- b) In 2019, during the visit of Xi-Xinping, Russia - China entered into, "Comprehensive Strategic Partnership" for New Era.
- c) In 2020, Russia has started sharing the Military Technology with China.
- d) Russia keeps on lecturing India for not getting involved in "Anti-China War Games" by the dubious western Strategy of Indo-Pacific.
- e) Since, 2012 Russia and China are conducting Naval Exercises in East China and South China sea & from 2021 onwards they are conducting Naval Exercises in western Pacific.
- f) 2022 - Putin visited China, for the inauguration of Winter Olympics where the 2 Countries described their relationship as "No limit Partnership".

During the visit Putin described that the Partnership is Greater than the Traditional Alliance.

8) 2023 — Xi-Xinping visited Moscow, Putin describe China as "Good Old Friend"

- When they described their Partnership as no limit in 2022, after the declaration Russia started war in Ukraine.

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In 2023, during Xi-Xinping's visit, they have agreed to take concrete steps to cement the No limit Partnership.

What is the Real Concern for India and the West? —

— Material Partnership — Trade, Commerce, Energy turning into "ideological Alliance". The way it used to be in the early days of Cold War.

Ideological Alliance in Present time —

- i) Anti-west! — Against the concept of Indo-Pacific.

What is in Store for India? —

As far as the New Foreign Policy Concept is concerned.

Is there any Silver lining for India? —

There is a definite Silver lining if India smells the tea leaves.

What India should pay attention? —

- Russia clearly mentions that it favours the Multi-Polar world. Russia-India-China triangle is the basis of the Multi-Polar world. It means Russia sees itself as the Pole & not as the Satellite. Means Russia aim to asserts its Strategic Autonomy.

How Russia can assert its Economy ? -

By working with India. Thus, India and Russia are the Natural Partners.

Why ? -

- Both want to balance the rise of China. Both have territorial disputes with China.

China has habit of making historical Claims on the territorial of other states.

Russia and China had undergone a minor border conflict in 1960s. China has started describing itself as "Near Arctic State".

China is not only a revisionist State, China is also a Revanchist State (laying Claims on territories of others).

It is to be noted today, Russia needs India more than India needs Russia.

India has advised Russia, time and again that, one old friend is better than "2 New Friends".

i) China

ii) Pakistan.

Russia - China relationship is not the only concerns, Russia's Expanding Relations with Pakistan should not be ignored.

* Views of Sri-Nath Raghvan :-

title of the Article — "The Myth of Idyllic Indo-Russian ties."

Though both the govt.

keep on repeating the long standing time tested Friendship but in International Politics, there is no Permanent Friends and No Permanent Enemy.

Russia's Flirtations with Pakistan are not New.

They are considering Pakistan as the Zipper State of Eurasia, Russia can't ignore Pakistan.

Pakistan is also known as Rentier State.

Thus it is natural for Russia to look for better Relation with Pakistan.

In Post^{Cold} War Environment, Pakistan's importance has increased for Russia b/c of the different Reasons.:-

i) Pakistan is Epicentre of Terrorism.

Hence, for the security of Russia's oil rich regions, Russia should be in talking terms with Pakistan.

ii) Pakistan's influence in Afghanistan. Since Pakistan had influence over Taliban, Russia worked with Pakistan in Afghanistan, to install Taliban govt. At the same time, not to give Strategic advantage to US.

iii) Since 2008, when India-US civil Nuclear Deal took the final shape, Russia has started Greater Engagement with Pakistan.

iv) Civil Nuclear Deal will result into US getting more Defence Contract. Hence, Russia has to diversify the buyers of its weapon system.

v) The Current State of Russia-China Relation also bring Russia close to Pakistan.

Russia wants to diversify its Energy Export in Nuclear Energy. In past few years Russia has provided even offensive weapons to Pakistan.

For Ex - Mi 35 attacked Helicopters in 2014.

In 2015, Russia and Pakistan entered into Defence Co-operation Agreement, the details of w/c are not in Public.

In 2021, Russia announced providing special Military Equipments.

Russia has also started investing in Gas pipelines Project in Pakistan.

What is approach of India ? -

Formerly, India always pronounce that India - Russia relationship is time-tested.

India expresses that it has confident in the relations.

However, India has also given Friendly advice -

"One ~~old~~ old Friend is better than 2 New Friends".

India is only country of significance w/c has no problem in rise of Russia. On the other hand, China will always prefer a weak Russia w/c can't assert itself in Siberia or Central Asia.

China's Current Policy is to keep war in Ukraine going.

Russia and specially Putin should not forget the role of disintegration of USSR w/c Putin considers as Greatest Geo-Political disasters.

Pakistan's Flirtations with Russia are to get better bargain from US.

What India needs to do ?-

Have a Candid dialogue.

Why ? -

- B/c Putin is Hard core Realist.

What Modi has to tell to Putin ?-

Russia can make good relations with Pakistan and China but do not cross the Red line.

Russia should not do anything that can harm India's core interest while ~~delivering~~ weapons to these states.

It is also essential that India should understand the present realities. -

- i) In the age of complex interdependence countries seek multiple alignment.
- ii) Russia is not USSR, and India ^{at} present is not so much dependent on Russia.

*Analysing the Current State of Relations !-

War in Ukraine has proved to be a testing ground for India - Russia relations too.

India has stood firm in support of Russia. India did not vote in any of the Resolution brought by the west against Russia. India had to face the tremendous pressure from the west yet, India maintained its Strategic Autonomy.

India has emerged as "Voice of Reason in the World with its principle stand in Ukraine War".

- i) India didn't support Russia just b/c of India's dependency on Russia but also b/c India believes that only Russia is not responsible for the war.
- ii) India has made its stand clear that war should be stopped and they should go for Political Settlements of the dispute.
- iii) India has provided Humanitarian support to Ukraine also.
- iv) India also knows that Ukraine is also not entirely free from Fault.

How West has looked at India's position ? -

West accuses India of taking the advantage of the situation from the perspective of West, India's approach has been very transactional. India is buying the Cheap oil thus alongwith China is playing the keyrole in making the Sanctions ineffective.

A/c to West, India should have taken Strategic approach.

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If war ends it will be good for World Economy. However, till Russia gets resources, it will remain engaged.

However, India's position is clear b/c the entire blame can't be put only on Russia.

A/c to Foreign Minister, it is "War of West with Russia and not India's War with Russia".

India will do what is in the best interest of people of India.

Lila- Not only India, entire developing world is suffering b/c of this unnecessary war.

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